must exist. *Astrophysicists* proposed the method of search and gave crucial guidance at several steps along the way. *Observational astronomers* identified HDE 226868, the companion of Cyg X-l; they used periodically shifting spectral lines from it to weigh Cyg X-l; and they made extensive other observations to firm up their estimate of its weight. *Experimental physicists* created the instruments and techniques that made possible the search for X-ray stars, and they carried out the search that identified Cyg X-l. *Engineers and managers* at NASA created the rockets and spacecraft that carried the X-ray detectors into Earth orbit. And, not least in importance, *American taxpayers* provided the funds, several hundreds of millions of dollars, for the rockets, spacecraft, X-ray detectors and X-ray telescopes, and the salaries of the engineers, managers, and scientists who worked with them.

Thanks to this remarkable teamwork, we now, in the 1990s, are almost 100 percent sure that black holes exist not only in Cyg X-l, but also in a number of other binaries in our galaxy.

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1. Chapter 7. The electric field hair of a charged black hole is evenly distributed around the hole's spin axis and thus cannot produce a concentrated beam.